Read-01
The Birdman of India

There are many birds around us whether it's a city or a village. Most of us like watching colourful birds. However, there was a man who was so involved in their study that he was nicknamed 'The Birdman of India'. The name Dr. Salim Moizuddin Abdul Ali is synonymous with birds. He made birds a serious pursuit (attempt at achieving/gaining something) when it used to be mere fun for the most.

Orphaned (lost his parents) at a very young age, Salim Ali was brought up by his maternal uncle. As a child Salim was given an expensive air gun as a present and spent all his time shooting sparrows around the house. One day he noticed that one of the sparrows he had shot at had a yellow throat. He couldn't hold (was unable to stop) his curiosity and approached his uncle. His uncle who was equally clueless (no information/knowledge or idea of something) took him to the Bombay Natural History Society (BNHS) in the hope of finding an answer. There, the honorary secretary, W. S. Milliard told him that the bird was the Yellow Throated Sparrow. Milliard also told him about the variety of sparrows. That day Salim decided that he was going to be an ornithologist (a person who studies birds). No one would have imagined that the bird shooter would become a bird lover and nature conservator (a person who protects values or things) one day!!

Inclination (desire/feeling that makes you work in a direction) and choice of a novel (new) career option made Salim's life full of hardship.

As a young man Salim had to face years of unemployment. He moved to Burma to look after the family mining and timber business. It was a rewarding experience for the naturalist as there were endless opportunities for exploring the forests of Burma.

How will Salim Ali relate his interest and his career?

After returning to India, Salim tried to get a job as an ornithologist with the Zoological Survey of India but was rejected since he did not have an M. Sc or Ph.D. degree. He decided to study further to acquire eligibility (ability to do something/requirement) for the job. Salim went to Germany and got trained under Professor Stresemann, an acknowledged (well-known) ornithologist in Berlin. However, when he came back to India, he found out that there were still hardly any opportunities in his profession. Another man would have given up in disgust, but not Salim. He decided to create an opportunity. He went to the Bombay Natural History Society (BNHS) and offered his free services for conducting regional ornithological surveys.

Says Salim Ali, "It is seldom one gets an opportunity in life to do what one wants to do. I think the best results are those when you are doing something worthwhile which you enjoy doing without the motivation of material reward."

It was his sincerity that won him many awards and medals from all over the world including the Padma Shree and Padma Vibhushana.

Salim Ali was a true nature lover and his love for the wildlife is expressed in his autobiography (The Fall of a Sparrow) where he calls the wildlife a capital, an asset and says, "The interest on the capital must be used, while leaving the capital itself intact. This is

how I interpret wildlife conservation and believe that future generations should enjoy the same fun with it that I had."

The Birdman is survived (continued to live) by his books on birds that a small group of people use to enjoy birding and endeavour for the conservation of the wildlife. Dr. Ali is no more but his legacy lives on.

How can we pay a tribute to this Birdman?

Let's pay a tribute to the Birdman by learning to identify a few birds around us. Before you start, study the names of different body parts of a bird given in the picture. It will help you understand the descriptions as well as will enable you to describe birds.

The following are the descriptions of some common birds around us. Read the features and try to notice them when you see them next.

(1) **White breasted Kingfisher:** Size : Between Myna and Pigeon (28 cm). White throat and centre of breast, brown head and most of under parts. Seen at ponds, puddles, rain filled ditches, inundated (water covered) paddy fields and near seashore.
Food : fish, tadpoles, lizards, grasshoppers and other insects. Nesting Season: March to July.

(2) **Indian Robin:** Size: Sparrow + (19 cm). A black bird with a white patch on wing. Reddish vent. Male has white shoulders and black under parts.
Food: Insects and their eggs, worms, spiders, etc. Nesting season: April to June.

(3) **Iora :** Size : Sparrow (14 cm). A black and yellow bird with two white wing bars. Male and female are better differentiated by a black tail. Crown and mantle of breeding males vary from uniformly black to black mixed with much yellow on mantle.
Food: Insect, their eggs and larvae. Nesting season: Chiefly May to September.

(4) **Red-wattled lapwing :** size: Partridge (Village Hen) +/- (32-35 cm). Black cap and breast, red bill with black tip, and yellow legs.
Food: Insects, grubs, etc. Nesting Season: March to August. It is one of the rare birds that lay eggs on ground.

(5) **Paddy Bird/Pond Heron:** Size: smaller than cattle egret (40-48 cm). Earthy brown in colour when at rest but with the glistening white wings, tail and rump flashing when it flies.
Food: Frogs, fish, crabs and insects. Nesting Season: May to September.

(6) **Rive Tern :** Size: Crow size (38-46 cm). Orange yellow bill, black cap, grayish white under parts.
Food : Fish, prawns, swimming crabs. Nesting Season: May-June.

(7) **Bronze-winged Jacana :** Size: Equivalent to village hen (28-31 cm). Dark upper-wing and under-wing, bronze green upper part and blackish under part.
Food : Seeds, roots, etc. Nesting Season: June to September.

(8) **Indian Roller/Blue Jay :** Size: Pigeon (33 cm). Rufous-brown on nape (back of neck) and under parts, white streaking on ear coverts and throat, and greenish mantle. Food : Insects. Nesting Season: February to March.

Read-02
Her Words, His Vision

One afternoon while waiting for her husband to finish a business meeting, Mansi toured (visited) an art museum. She was looking forward to a quiet view of the masterpieces.

A young couple viewing the paintings ahead of her chattered (kept talking) nonstop between themselves. She observed them a moment and found the lady only talking all the time. Mansi thought of the man and admired his patience for putting up with her constant parade of words.

Mansi gazed at (kept looking) them several times as she moved through the various rooms of art. Each time she heard the lady's constant gush of words, she moved away quickly.

Will Mansi go and stop them talking?

Mansi was standing at the counter of the museum gift shop making purchase when the couple approached the exit. Mansi observed the 'couple carefully. The man after paying the bill pulled out a white stick and tapped his way towards the gate.

"He's a brave man." the clerk at the counter said. n Most of us would give up if we were blinded at such a young age. During his recovery, he made a vow that his life wouldn't change. So, as before, he and his wife come in whenever there's a new art show."

"But what does he get out of the art?" Mansi asked. "He can't see." What pleasure do you think a blind person gets in visiting a museum?

"Can't see! You are wrong. He sees a lot. More than you or I do," the clerk said. "His wife describes each painting through his mind's eye. So he can see."

Mansi learned something about patience, courage and love, that day. She saw the patience of young wife describing paintings to a person without sight and the courage of a husband who would not allow blindness to alter his life.

Mansi witnessed the love shared by the two people as she watched this couple walk away with their arms interwind. "Really her words are his vision" said Mansi.

Read-03
Final Game

Before the final game, life was ordinary, daily routine. Each day I awakened with a mental list of tasks I had to complete before the end of the day. My life wasn't too complicated: class, soccer (football) practice, studying and sleep. Often I returned home from soccer field after heavy practice to study until the early hours of the morning.

Having accepted well to my daily routine, I never imagined it would be altered. However, my life changed the day on the final game. It was the last game of the tournament; and winner would achieve 'championship.' My team had been under vigorous (tough) physical training for the past four years in anticipation of this day. But emotionally we were ready as well. I was ready. I entered the game with the mindset that the title was in our hands. We deserved it because our desire to win was great!

Do you think that their team will win?

"Captains!" called the referee. I approached the centre of the field, and with confidence, looked in the eyes of my opponent while giving her a powerful handshake, wishing her luck. As I took my position on the field, I knew it was time for the final game to begin. I took a deep breath and reassured myself that I would give this game best of my abilities as if it were the last game I ever played.

"Goalie, Goalie," called the man dressed in black and white. The two goalies simultaneously raised their right hands in air, indicating that they were ready. The game could begin. This was it. The whistle sounded, and the ball was soon kicked in my direction. I received the ball and kicked it twenty feet toward the goal just in time for my teammate to meet it and pound (strike, hit) it right into the net. 'Goal" everyone shouted. The game had started out well.

But the power of the game soon grew intense as the opposing team came right back at us with a goal to tie the game at one to one. The game continued at the extremely competitive level throughout the first half and into the second. The score was still tied at one to one, until I received the ball with one minute to go. I needed to put the ball in the net, and 1 did just that, making the final score two to one. But it didn't go exactly as planned.

What indication does the writer give in the previous sentence?

In an attempt to block my shot, my opponent challenged me in midair. But instead of heading the ball, her body slammed into mine leaving me unconscious in the middle of the field. My teammates shouted cries of victory and horror at the same time.

When I regained consciousness, I found myself in a hospital bed, surrounded by family, friends and teammates. Also at my side were doctors, the determiners of my future. In a matter of moments, they would tell me the severity of my injuries.

I was told that I would have to undergo an extremely rarer surgery. This type of surgery had only been performed a limited number of times, with a mere 50 percent success rate. After some thinking, I decided to undergo the surgery, knowing that either way, many challenges would await me. Would I be able to finish my studies? What effect would it have on my social life, my grades? These questions circled my head, and unfortunately, only time would provide answers.

How will the soccer player got adjusted to new changed situation?

After the surgery, I was no longer the independent person as before. I had to depend on others to assist me in even the simplest tasks. It was going to be a long tough road to recovery, and I knew I couldn't get through it without a positive attitude. Gradually I could adjust to the changes in my life. I began to realize that I didn't have to give up my old life completely and I focused my energy on a favourite pastime: writing. I was able to produce work of art in the silence and solace (supports) of my mind and spirit. Although I was not in physical control of half of my body, I still had control of my mind.

Looking back on the situation as a whole I am gl8d that the final game was, in fact, my final game. I have no regrets. I said, "I would give it best of my abilities and I did that and ultimately, I came out a winner." Although my accident robbed me of my physical abilities, it left me with power of mind and forced me to discover my inner self. That final

game was more rewarding. Not only did we win, but I was able to discover a new level within. I guess I gained two victories that day.

Read-04
I Love Me

Hello, I'm Swayam Saxena.

When I was younger, I was very shy. Whenever I even thought of speaking to new people about anything, my whole head would turn red. I'm sure people could even see me withdrawn from behind my back.

By the time I reached high school, I was so stressed out by the thought of answering question and doing group projects that my self confidence problem would get in the way of my ability to study.

I was nervous and. agitated about being wrong and how people would react to me. My school and work started to suffer. Because of my inferiority complex, I couldn't go out. I was afraid of even going for shopping. I couldn't speak to people or mark decisions. I hid myself away and felt like a real loser.

That's when my negativity made me upset. There was nothing that I didn't over analyze and criticize. The combination of my self-criticism, low self-confidence and bad self-image was starting to destroy the life I wanted to build for myself.

What do you suggest Swayam to do to a 'overcome his self criticism?

I had to conquer (overcome) my low self esteem (love for the self). I had no other option.

One day I made a decision to change, and I started to read everything I could about self-help.

I wanted to be a speaker end an author. Seema odd, I know, but it was my lifelong dream. I was other people standing up, making a difference, and doing it with an ease that I couldn't even fathom (understand).

Why was it so difficult for me? I realized then that I I needed to:

What will be the result of such a realization?

Understand exactly why I felt low.

⇨ Figure out why I was thinking everything as negative - The way people looked at me, their comments, their actions... it was literally destroying me.

⇨ Understand how much harm I was causing myself.

⇨ Find effective ways to pause, recognize my negative behavior, and eliminate (remove, get rid of) the obstacles I was creating for myself - I was the only one with the power to do it.

The Results ...

Once I discovered the techniques that worked for me, my confidence grew and I began to see challenges as opportunities to move forward and succeed.

Now I enjoy meeting people and my relationships are much getter. I have more friends and can rely on them when I feel myself slipping back to where I was before.

I am achieving my goals with ease because I have developed my self confidence.

I no longer miss the opportunities that life offers. I am more optimistic and my mind no longer limits me.

Life is finally good!

What about you?

This is a short checklist to help you test how much you love yourself. Answer the questions as honestly as you can and total your scores at the bottom of the page.

Sr. no	Statements	Always	Sometimes	Rarely
1.	I have a lot of doubts about my abilities.			
2.	I am often unkind about myself,			
3.	I don't like what I see in the mirror.			
4.	I blame myself when things go wrong.			
5.	I personalise things when someone says something I don't understand.			
6.	I don't feel I'm very important in life.			
7.	I don't have good nurturing relationships with people.			
8.	I feel I am not good enough as a person.			
9.	I think negative thoughts.			
10.	I don't respect myself.			
11.	I don't like things I say or do			
12.	I lack confidence in situations.			
13.	I don't value myself.			

Now score your responses. Always = 2, sometimes = 1 and rarely = 0 Total your score and s and the following interpretations.

0-8: You have a strong love for yourself that is capable of bringing quite a lot of change and helps you feel in control of your life. Keep trusting your intuition and continue feeling good about yourself

9-13: You have a moderate love for yourself. If you are conscious of your negativity towards you, try and identify the areas of your life that have contributed to this. Try and let false opinions of yourself go.

14-26: A score in this range suggests you have a number of concerns about yourself and or your life. These concerns are likely to feed a negative self-image and could upset your chances of feeling successful or positive about yourself. It is important to recognise which aspects of your life you're unhappy with and decide to tackle one aspect of something in order to put you back in control.

Here are some strategies for building love for one's own self:

- ⇨ Free yourself from "should've". Live you life on the basis of what is possible for you and what feels right to you instead of what you or others think you "should" do. Find out what you want and what you are good at.
- ⇨ Respect your own needs. Respecting your deeper needs will increase your sense of worth and well-being.
- ⇨ Set achievable goals. Establish goals on the basis of what you can realistically achieve, and then work step-by-step to develop your strength.
- ⇨ Talk to yourself positively. When you notice that you are doubting or judging yourself, replace such thoughts with self-supportive direction.
- ⇨ Seek out and put yourself in situations in which the probability of success is high.
- ⇨ Take chances. New experiences are learning experiences, which can build self-confidence. Expect to make mistakes as part of the process; don't be disappointed if you don't do it perfectly. Feel good about trying something new, making progress and increasing your competence.
- ⇨ Solve problems. Don't avoid problems. Face them, and identify ways to solve them or cope with them.
- ⇨ Make decisions. Trust yourself to deal with the results.
- ⇨ Develop your skills. Know what you can and can't do.
- ⇨ Focus on what you can do rather than what you cannot.

Read-06
I Miss You, Mother

Early in the autumn of 1984, my mother began writing the story of her life. She was an energetic woman in her seventies. It was her desire to put down her thoughts and memories in her "My Book". Once she came for dinner and told me that she had to work on her book. I laughed and asked her where the fire was. The fire was inside her. She finished her b<?ok in early December. Three days after Christmas, her cancer was discovered and three months later she was dead.

From my Mother's book:

I have loved family, friends, nature, animals, music and many other things. It will be hard to say good bye to those I love and to the beauty in the world.

I read these words for the first time when I was surrounded by packing boxes in my mother's apartment, a month after her death. I tried to picture her face as I read the words but the memories of the last two months as she lay dying, were too painful. I closed her book.

On a rainy Sunday afternoon, one year from the day my mother was admitted to the hospital. I suddenly knew the time had come to remember and honour her life and her death, For a month I kept on reading the notebook I had kept during her hospitalization and my mother's book When I finished reading, I realized that my mother was no longer lost to me; in some new and different way I had regained her.

From my notes, dated January 21, 1985.

My mother continues to amaze me. Despite what is happening to her body, she continues to appreciate nature and the small bits of life. Her room no. 235 has a large window. She enjoys watching birds busily flying outside.

Her pain is awesome (severe). She can no longer sit up. Today is her grandson's birthday, and somehow she managed to write a note to him. One day I will tell him of the unimaginable amount of effort his grandmother put into writing this note.

One warm day is February, I opened the window in her room. The soft, scented air spilled in. My mother 0 en d her eyes and asked, "Is the grass beginning to grow?"

I closed my eyes and stream of memory ran across.

From my diary when I was five years old:

I have stepped out of the house in the middle of a summer night to watch the grass and flowers in our garden. Suddenly my mother is at my side. Instead of sending me back to bed. she coins me, we sit here together. Listening to the noise made By cicadas (a type of insect). "Look" she says pointing to a shooting star. But I am looking at the light in her eyes. Later I fall asleep with my head in her lap.

I remember the day my mother ask d that I write a last message from her to each member of the family I '1rote through my tears. I was aware that while my mother ha accept I her death, I hadn't. Over the next few days, my mother wanted total" about h r life so we began our long, final conversation. As we talked, the picture of my mother's life grew stronger.

From my mother's book:

I haven't forgotten what it's like to be young all the hopes and anxieties and the sensation in everything you do is going to advance or wreck your life. No in -betweens when you are young.

My ambition was to go on a stage. My sister and I took dancing lessons and practiced difficult steps. In those days I thought I'd be a famous actress! It was all a dream of course.

Lying in the hospital my mother had other dreams. One morning she awoke, and told me of her dream. She had seen a man fall from a roof. All that day her thought were of falling.

"Don't be afraid" I reassured her. "Of course, I will catch you. For all those years when I was growing up, you caught me. Now it's my turn."

Her face relaxed under the oxygen mask. But I knew there would come a time - and soon - when I would have to let her go.

And so would she.

From my notes. March 1, 1985.

She is very weak and her breathing is irregular. But the spirit is still connected to the world. When I held the pot of flowers close to her, she said delightedly, "Oh" that's so pretty! Isn't wonderful how life goes on?"

That next to last evening of my mother's life, she stared out of the windows into the blackness.

"What are you looking at?" I asked her.

"Nothing." She replied.

"Well" I said "Look at me."

More than anything else I wanted her last moments more than anything else. I wanted them to be spent looking at the face of someone who loved her.

The summer after my mother died, when the first yellow lily appeared, I ran into the house to telephone my mother with the news. Then I remembered that she is no more. Even now, I keep thinking of things I ought to tell her, things I want to ask her. She had a way of giving perspective to my life.

From my mother's book,

When I turned seventy, someone asked me how it felt to have arrived at such an age well even though my body isn't the same, I am still the same. I will always be the girl who loved cats and flowers and raced home from school to practice my dancing lessons. Inside I am still that person.

I miss the person.

Read-7
The Princess and The Tiger

There was once a King. If anyone committed a serious crime in the kingdom, the King did not condemn (give punishment) him to death Instead the criminal would be taken to a large arena (a place for public events). All the people would come to see the show. In the arena there were two doors. Behind one door there was a fierce and hungry tiger. Behind the other there was a beautiful young girl. The man would not know which door was which. He would have to choose one of the two doors. If he chose well, he had to marry the girl If he chose badly... the tiger would eat him.

The king had a very beautiful daughter. One day he found out that she had fallen in 1ove with a poor young soldier in his army. The king was very angry. The soldier was arrested and taken to the arena

The princess knew which door concealed (hid) the tiger and which one concealed the beautiful girl. However, she was a very jealous princess and did not want the soldier to marry the girl behind the door. Neither did shw want to see her lover killed by the tiger.

When the soldier was brought into the arena he looked up and saw the princess sitting next to her father.

What signal do you think she made to the soldier? And what happened to the soldier in the end?

Read-08
Ananya Writes to His Parents

Dear Mummy, Dear Pappa
I love you both.

Yesterday I saw a child on a merry go round. He waved at his parents every round. The parents waved back too. The incident ran through my mind the whole day and I kept asking a question to myself: 'Where do the parents get patience from to express love for their child in trivial (small) activities of life?' For searching the answer, I went back to my childhood and realized that on each day of your life, you made deposits in the memory banks of your children. In bringing me and Asmi up, you had built self-esteem first and our house later. You had finger-paint (painting the fingers) more and pointed the finger less. You had done less correcting but more connecting. You had run through more fields and gazed at more stars for us.

Today I am just crossing the border between my childhood and adulthood. I am no longer a child now. In these years of my adolescence, I have unlimited confusions. I have started feeling that 'growing up' is quite scary, whereas being a 'grown up' has many attractions. The responsibilities that go with growing age often come as surprise. I think now I have started developing an understanding about why and how you did what for us.

For last several years, I have been talking about my freedom. I remember the day when you objected to my' dress and hair. That day you appeared to me like an ' evil dictators (absolute rulers), who would never understand my style, my personality. The next day you did not allow me to go out. I was fiercely angry on you. We were on opposite sides and there seemed no meeting grounds. Now, when I recall this incident, I also remember how you appreciated (praised) my choice when we had to buy a gift for Asmi. I also recall how after getting angry on me for the bad report card for a few hours, both of you came into my room and explained what I should do to score more marks. I have both the types of memory but now I would prefer to remember the best. The little and big mishaps between us were just thoughtless reactions.

I need you both to be with me and understand me about my decisions regarding what's wrong and what's right. I wish to try out my ways to deal with the situations around me. I recall that when I was learning to walk, I used to fall quite often. But with your love and care, I learnt to get up and run. While experimenting in my life I know, I may fail, but I am also sure that you will be there with me. I have learnt from you that experience generates strength to begin anew after committing mistakes.

I have seen you both and Asmi argue over what she should become. Mummy... Pappa,1 know, you have a right to suggest what fits her personality the best. But as 'understanding persons' let us respect her feelings and her wishes. Our over aspirations might suffocate her growth. You might disagree to what I think. But this is what I feel and think. I hope you also want Asmi to venture on the path of life with her own maturity. Trust in her abilities and a little encouragement will facilitate her to learn how to respond to changing situations.

Reading this, you must be feeling that your Ananya has really become 'a man'. Yes, I have grown up. You both have contributed to my 'understanding'. I love you both for your wise, timely counsel (advise) and friendly attitude. I am sure we will live as a happy family 'forever'.

Your loving son,

Read-9
Vismay@search

It is almost a week now. Vismay, a bright, ambitious and hardworking student of 12th Science looks confused to his class teacher. One day during the recess, the teacher sat for lunch with Vismay and asked, "You are hardworking and scoring very well in all the subjects then why are you so much worried over something? If you have any problem you can share it with me."

Vismay didn't speak for a while. He was staring at a tree outside the window. The teacher held Vismay by his shoulder and said, "Feel free, and do not hesitate. Every problem has a solution."

Vismay took a deep breath and said, "Actually.... I am thinking about my studies after 12th. I don't know much about aeronautics but I want to know more about it and wish to join the course somewhere. But... I...don't know anything about a college that offers such course."

How will Vismay solve his problem?

"Is this the reason...!!!", exclaimed the teacher. "Thanks to the internet. It's not at all a problem now. Come with me. Within half an hour, you will be free from your worries. By the way, do you have an access to the internet?"

"I access the net for e-mail only."

'That's good. You will be able to understand quickly then."

After the lunch, the teacher took Vismay to the computer lab, logged on to the internet and said, "Here you are!! Read this... it gives all information on what is aeronautical engineering."

"Its' so fast..... How did you do it within no time, Sir? Can I get Information on anything? Can I also know about institutions that offer courses in aeronautical engineering?", Vismay was exited.

"Yes, my boy... with the help of Search Engines, you need not depend on libraries or any other source for getting information."

"What is his Search Engine?" asked Vismay.

"A web Search Engine is a tool designed to search for information on the World Wide Web. All you need to do is to enter a word or a phrase in the search engine and it will display the list of websites in which the word/phrase occurs", replied the teacher.

"Is it difficult to use a search engine?"

"Not at all ... All you need 'to know is how to make your search effective as the internet has piles of information You need to learn three simple steps to do it. Let me show you how to search!!

Step One: Identify the Keyword/phrase

Decide what you want to search for and prepare a list of keywords or phrases that will describe what you want to search for before you log on to the Internet.

For example, you want to know institutes or colleges that offer aeronautical engineering, isn't it? So for that our key phrase will be:

Institute of aeronautical engineering

This will give you a list of websites that have the words "institute", "aeronautical" and "engineering" in them. It would be a very big list. If you want to limit your search, you can put your phrase in toll. For example,

"Institute of aeronautical engineering"

It will search for the websites that have exactly the same phrase or sentence in it.

Step Two: Start Searching

Once the list is ready, log on to the net, go to any search engine and enter the keyword or phrase in the search box, click on 'Search' button and your search will begin.

Tips for entering the keyword:

(1) Search is always case insensitive. Searching for [Solar System] is the same as searching for [solar system].

(2) With some exceptions, punctuation is ignored. You can't search for @ # $ % ^ & * ( ) = + [] / and other special characters.

(3) Always use a group of words while searching instead of a single word. This will help you get focused results.

(4) When you want to use two or more phrases during the search use the + sign. Example: grammar + exercise or preposition + exercise. This will search for the sites that have both grammar/preposition and exercise in them.

(5) If your keyword is a phrase and you want to search for websites that have the exact phrase in it, then add quotation marks " " and a plus sign. Example: "+English Language Teaching".

Step Three: Narrow down the search

After entering the keywords and getting the results for the search, you can use the Search within Results option to narrow down on the sites you are interested in. Scroll down the page and go to Search within Results option. For example, you may specify the city of your choice by entering name in the Search within Results box.

"It's so easy. I can use a search engine to get additional information on the topics of my syllabus, too."

"Exactly! Let me also show you how to read search results.

The search engine's goal is to provide you with results that are clear and easy to read. Generally, four titles are used to read the search results:

1. **The title:** The first line of any search result is the title of the webpage.
2. **The snippet:** A description of or an excerpt from the webpage.
3. **The URL :** The webpage's address.
4. **Cached link:** A link to an earlier version of this page. Click here if the page you wanted isn't available.

I am sure you will learn as you start using search engines. Experience is the best teacher. There are many more things to learn but own your own. I think the best way to start with is

to start searching additional information on your textbook topics. So, start using search engines and keep yourself updated and abreast of the new information. Dear Vismay, internet is full of information on almost all subjects. What you need to have is curiosity. All the best!!"

Read-11
The Locked Gate

A guru had two disciples who were in the habit of arguing with each other. Often the two accompanied the guru when he went out on a pilgrimage or went to visit his other disciples. While he walked in silence, the disciples went on exchanging words heatedly. Each one stuck to his point of view, unwilling to see any truth in the other.

One day the guru set out for the capital. The two disciples accompanied him. As usual, they argued over many issues most of which were useless.

A heavy shower detained (prevented from leaving or doing something) them midway at a rest-house. They resumed their journey after the rains subsided. By the time they approached the town, it was past midnight. The capital was protected by a high circular wall and the gates used to be locked at midnight by sentries (soldiers who guard the buildings) who camped atop the wall.

Will the gates be opened for them?

The guru and his disciples found three persons standing before the gate and shouting at one another. They were about to come to blows. In the moonlight, the sentries seated atop the wall were enjoying their quarrel.

The guru observed the three men and listened to their angry exchanges. He soon understood the cause of their dispute. The three were the residents of the town, but had been locked out as they were late in returning from some pleasure-trip. One of them, who was drunk, proposed that they should storm the gate and march into the town over the smashed metal-plated doors. "Heroes that we are, this will be the right thing for us to do," he claimed.

The second man, who was under the influence of opium said that they should jump over the wall. "That is going to be as exciting as flying!" he asserted.

The third one who was under the influence of Ganja, insisted on creeping through the key-hole. "That would be great fun!" he insisted.

As each disputed the wisdom of the other two. There was pandemonium (noisy and uncontrolled behaviour of people).

The guru silenced them. "Why don't each of you do what you . would like to do?" he asked. More categorically (clearly) he asked the first man to smash the doors and the second man to jump over the wall and the third man to pass through the key-hole.

They licked their lips, blinked at the guru and did not know what to say or do.

Meanwhile the chief sentry had recognized the guru. He climbed down and opened the doors and received him respectfully.

As the guru and his two disciples entered the gates, the other three followed suit.

"Most of the arguments are like this-unrelated to reality. None of the three could have done what he proposed to do. Yet he was eager to prove the superiority of his method over the other methods. What is more important, there was a method different from theirs-a

simple and healthy method. That was to give their identity to the sentries and request them to open the gates. They would rather cling to their false and unreal methods than think of the simple and true method," observed the guru.

The two disciples kept quiet. They understood what the guru had in mind-their conduct.

What did you learn from this story?

Many beliefs are imposed on others in the name of religion which are insignificant. Controversies resulting from discussion over such issues are meaningless and avoidable. Often ignorance and ego are the major barriers (blocks) in solving complex situations. Whereas a humble mind can avoid unnecessary debate and present a simple solution to even complex issues.

Read-12
Joy of Reading

Dear friends,

Reading and understanding a poem is not at all difficult. In fact, reading a poem is an experience. Let's experience a poem by Rabindranath Tagore.

REMEMBERING

I don't remember my mother.
Only this: sometimes when I'm at play,
suddenly, for no reason at all,
a tune begins to buzz
and ring in my ears,
and my mother comes
and merges with my play.
May be she used to sing,
rocking me.
She has gone
and left her song behind.

I don't remember my mother.
Only this: when in Ashwin
at dawn among Shiuli trees
the scent of their flowers
is borne by the dewy breeze,
somehow then she comes back to my mind
my mother.
Long ago perhaps she gathered Shiulis,
filling her basket.
So the scent of Puja
returns as her scent.

I don't remember my mother.
Only this: when I sit by the window of my bedroom
and look at the far blue sky,
it seems to me my mother's looking at me with steady eyes.
Long ago she used to hold me on her lap and look at my face.
That's the look she has left in all the sky

Dear Readers,

The background life of the poet or a writer gets reflected in his/her writing, usually. You may also try to know about life of Rabindranath Tagore in order to understand the poem. Before we go ahead, try to answer the following questions.

- Do you agree with the poet when he says "I don't remember my mother..."? Why?
- Is the poet alone or with somebody?
- What reminds the poet of his mother?

Remembering is a well structured poem. All the three stanzas have eleven lines in it. You may also notice a theme in each stanza. The first stanza emphasizes on SOUND effect. The poet has used words like 'tune', 'buzz', 'ring', 'sing', and 'song'. You may also try to know the meanings of some other such words like, 1. Patter, 2. Rattle, 3. Tap, 4. Jingle, 5. Tinkle, 6. Bang etc for better understanding of it.

As we move on to the next stanza, we come across words of Indian origin- Ashwin, Puja and Shiuli. Ashwin means the month of Aaso(mid September - mid October). Puja, in this poem refers to Durga puja in Bengal and Shiuli (Parijat) are star shaped white flowers with orange tubes and sweet smell. They blossom at night and in the morning can be seen carpeting the ground. The poet has used the word 'scent' for Shiuli flowers. Why doesn't he use 'fragrance' or 'perfume' for flowers? 'Fragrance' and 'Perfume' are long words while 'scent' is more common and short. The stanza connects the readers through the sense of smell.

Try to find the meaning of the following words:

1. Odour, 2. Aroma, 3. Pong, 4. Stench, 5. Smell, 6. Stink

The poet has repeated the word 'look' in the third stanza. Would it be possible to use words like 'see', 'watch', 'observe', 'stare' or 'gaze' instead? Why?

The word selection is very carefully done in the poem. Read the first line of the poem: 'I don't remember my mother'. 'r' and 'm' sounds are repeated in this line and the line is repeated in the second and the third stanza as well. Repetition of sounds and a line create an impact on our mind as we read. The poet doesn't use the word like 'recall' or 'recollect' because both these words mean deliberately trying to remember something while the use of 'suddenly' and 'for no reason' show that there is no deliberate effort to remember the mother.

Thus, we can enjoy and appreciate any poem that we read. It's not difficult at all. Does the poem remind you of any other poem?

Read-13
I Keep My Tryst with Everest

I got up at 4:00 in the morning, melted snow and brewed (boiled and prepared tea) tea.

After a light breakfast of a few biscuits and half a slab of chocolate, I left my tent at around 5:30 a.m. Ang Dorjee was standing outside. No one else was about.

Ang Dorjee was going to climb without oxygen. But because of this his feet would get very cold. He thus wanted to avoid long exposure at heights and a night at the Summit Camp. He had therefore to either get to the peak and back to the South Col the same day or abandon the attempt.

He was keen to start immediately and asked if I would like to go with him. Going to the top from the South Col and back in a day would be strenuous (full of activity which need lot of energy and effort) and tough and there was the risk of Ang Dorjee turning back if his feet got too cold. I, however, had full confidence in Ang Dorjee as well as in my stamina and climbing capability. Besides no one else was ready to move at that time.

Will the writer and Dorjee continue to climb?

At 6:20 when Ang Dorjee and I stepped out from the South Col, it was a perfect day. There was a gentle breeze but the cold was intense. I was, however, warm in my well-insulated (covered as not to allow heat to go out) climbing gear. We climbed unroped (without taking help of a rope). Ang Dorjee set a steady pace but I had no difficulty keeping up with him.

The steep (a sharp slope) frozen slopes were as hard and brittle (easily breakable) as sheets of glass. We had to use the ice-axe and I had to kick really hard to get the front teeth of the crampons (boots with spikes) to bite into the frozen surface. I took every step very deliberately on the dangerous stretches.

In less than two hours, we reached the Summit Camp. Ang Dorjee looked back and asked if I was tired. I replied, "No," to his surprise and delight. He told me that the earlier summit party had taken four hours to reach the Summit Camp and added that if we could keep our present pace, we would be on the summit by 1 :00 p.m..

Lhatoo was following us and caught up with (succeeded in reaching) us when we rested below the South Summit. After drinking some tea, we moved on. Lhatoo had brought a nylon rope so Ang Dorjee and I roped up while Lhatoo walked in the middle, holding the rope with one hand, more for balance than security.

Lhatoo noticed that I had been climbing with oxygen at about two and a half litres per minute against the normal four for these heights. After he increased the oxygen flow on my regulator, I found even the steeper stretches (distance) comparatively easy.

Beyond the South Summit, the breeze increased. At that height the eddies (a movement in air which goes round and round) of strong winds whipped up the powder snow, reducing visibility to nil. On many occasions, I had to get into a crouching position with my back to the onslaught of the icy wind saturated with fine particles of bone dry powder snow.

Can you climb a mountain in such a weather?

It was terrifying to stand erect on a knife-edge ridge, with a sheer drop on either side. I had to dig my ice-axe deep and secure myself by attaching the waist-strap to the ice-axe

head. There was some tricky climbing between the South Summit and what is popularly known as Hillary's Step. Ang Dorjee and Lhatoo were already over it, but I was still negotiating its vertical face when Ang Dorjee gesticulated towards the top. I was thrilled. The goal was near. With renewed vigour I was on top of step in seconds. The sun had made the snow soft and climbing was easier here than it had been earlier.

We trudged (walked slowly with heavy steps because of tiredness) in the heavy powder snow for some time. Then the gradient (slope) started easing off noticeably. A few steps later I saw that after only a couple of metres there was no upward climb. The slope plunged steeply down.

My heart stood still. It dawned on me that success was within the reach. And at 1 :07 p.m. on 23 May, 1984, I stood on top of Everest, the first Indian woman to have done so.

Do you think the writer is brave?

Read-14
City of Tobors

[The Tobors were strange beings. They came during the Third World War when a lot of people were killed. They built a huge city and became the rulers and they made the Nems their slaves.

The city was like a huge factory with a silver roof. The Nems had to live and work here and they never saw the sun. Most of them didn't care.

But some Nems did care. Nems like Derf and his friends Kram and Nor. They wanted to escape from the city and they met to talk about it.

There was a place in the city called The Centre. The Nems were never allowed to go there. Derf was sure this was their weak spot and that the Tobors got their powers from here. Somehow, soon, they must break into The Centre and destroy the Tobors.....]

That night, Derf couldn't sleep. He was thinking about how to get into The Centre. How? How? How?

In the morning, the lights came on in his room, and the bell rang. The bell woke the Nems every morning.

Derf got ready for work. He put on his grey uniform. The Nems had no other clothes to wear. When one uniform wore out, they got another one.

He spoke to the door, and it opened. Derf joined all the other Nems going to work.

Derfs workshop was on the fourth floor of the city. He took a lift. A Tobor was on duty at the door. He was counting the workers.

Derf joined the queue. The Tobor went on counting in his cold voice.

One hundred and two. One hundred and three. One hundred and four. One hundred and four, stop!"

Derf looked at the front of the queue. What was wrong? It was a female Nem holding a bundle. The bundle was crying.

The Tobor spoke.

"You cannot take this to work. It is forbidden (not allowed)".

The female Nem argued with him.'

"But he won't be any trouble. I can still work hard"

The Tobor's voice was as cold as steel. He wasn't angry. Tobors were never angry. They didn't seem to feel anything.

"It is forbidden," the Tobor said again. "Babies must go to the clinic. Take it away"'.

Derf was still with anger. How he hated the Tobors! If only he could fight them. But, there was no way - unless he got to The Centre.

Derf worked at a computer. It was a very simple one. The big computers were run by the Tobors.

Derf was feeding questions into his computer. It printed out answers, but his mind was far away. He was thinking about how to get to The Centre.

Then, Derfs computer made a new noise. He looked at it. It hadn't been able to answer the last question. Derf had made a mistake. He should have asked, "How many rooms are needed in the city by the year 2080?" But instead, he had asked, "How?"

It was a mistake. The computer couldn't answer a question like that. It seemed quite upset. Lights went on and off. It was trying hard to find an answer in its memory bank, but it could not. In the end, it printed out a new instruction to Derf, I don't understand this question. Please ask it in a different way.

Derf felt very excited. He had never seen this before. A computer breakdown, yes! But computer ignorance (The state of being ignorant), no!

Den started to feed lots of silly questions into his computer. It couldn't answer them. He fed the questions faster and faster, why? What? Where? How? When? Which?

The computer worked faster and faster. It clicked and hummed.

But it couldn't work. In the end, its lights went off, and it printed out its last message. Derf read it. Computer breakdown. Please repair.

Derf smiled. He had won a victory. It was a small victory, but it was a beginning.

That night, Derf told his friends. Kram and Norwere really excited. They could hardly believe the news. They worked on computers, too, and now they could break them. At last, they had a way to fight back.

"Tomorrow is the day," Derf said, "My computer will be mended. But, I'll break it again. You both do the same. Other Nems will see what's happening. May be they will join in. We can bring the whole workshop to a standstill!"

Kram was still afraid.

"What about the Tobors ? They always know everything. They'll know about this too."

"Not if we act together," Derf said, "if three computers break down, they'll think it's a power failure. They'll go to The Centre to find the breakdown. Then, we can follow them."

Nor's eyes were shining.

"It might work," he said. "Let's do it! Let's take our chance."

Next day, they went back to work, as usual. At 12.00 hours, the lunch pills were given out. Derf was too excited to swallow his. 14.00 hours was zero hours! He could hardly wait!

The time came, though. Derf began at once. He asked his computer silly questions. The same as yesterday. How ? Where ? What? Why? Which? Who?

The computer worked hard. It clicked louder and louder, but no answers came.

Then Derf asked another question.

Who are the Tobors? He tapped out.

He knew the question was forbidden. His computer went mad. Lights went on and off. Then, a red light flashed.

Question not allowed, it printed out.

Derf could hear Nor's computer and Kram's computer. They were both clicking and flashing. Other Nems were looking at the three computers. A Nem went over to Derf.

"What did you ask?" he said.

Derftold him.

The Nems shouted to the other workers. "Ask your machines about the Tabors! They can't answer the question."

There was an uproar (confused noise).

It was just Derf had hoped for. All the Nems began asking the same question, who are the Tabors?

The Tobar on duty got very worried. He came over to see. But he could do nothing. All the computers were breaking down. All at once!

The Tabor rang an alarm bell. Other Tabors rushed in. They just stood there and looked. They didn't know what to do. This had never happened before.

Derf watched them. The Tabors spoke to each other. Then, they went out. Derf followed at once.

They were going to The Centre. He was sure of it.

Nor and Kram joined him. Keeping out of sight, they followed the Tabors. It was lucky that the Tabors were so anxious to get to The Centre, they did not look back even once.

On the way, Derf and his friends got a shock. They passed a room that was full of unhappy sounds. The sounds were like Nems crying.

They went to look. The door had iron bars on it. Like a prison door. It was true. There were Nems inside. Both male and female. And they were crying.

Derf gasped (Breathed heavily, panted). He knew what this was. It was the Memory unit. All the Nems had cages over their heads. The cages were lit up. Their job was to take away the memory of the Nem prisoners.

Derf had seen Nems from the Memory unit before. They were poor things. Completely lost. And, they didn't live very long.

Derfs face became hard. The Tabors had a lot to answer for!

At last, they came to The Centre. The Tabors went in through a big, silver door. The door began to slide (Move smoothly over a surface) shut, but the Nems were quick. They ran fast, and just got in.

The Centre was a large room.

It had big computers all round it. And, in the centre, there was a giant computer. Derf looked at it with hate in his heart. He had been right, after all. This was the brain of the city.

There were some Tabors, too. They were standing in front of the big computer. They didn't see the Nems - not till it was too late.

Derf ran across to the computer. It was still working well. But one part had a lot of red lights flashing. They show d the breakdown in Derf's workshop. It was a very clever machine It even had a voice.

"Breakdown on the fourth floor." It said, "Loss of power. Please· investigate (To try to get information about something)." Derf ran forward, and pressed a button. The computer was now ready for questions.

"Who are the Tobors?" He yelled (Shouted in a loud or piecing way) at it.

A Tobor came up behind Derf, ready to kill him with a touch. But the Tobor was weak He had lost some ot his power. Because of the computer breakdown, he could no longer kill.

Derf kicked and struggled and made a hole in the Tobor's silver uniform. He couldn't believe his eyes. The Tobor's body was not like a Nem's body at all.

Derf put out his hand, and opened a door in the Tobor's chest. There were wires inside. The Tobor staggered (Walked unsteadily) back. It couldn't walk. It fell to its knees and crawled (Moved on the hands and knees)

Derf cried out to the others. It was a cry of victory.

"The Tabors are only machines! They aren't gods at all! They are only machines! They can be broken!"

The cry went round the city. The Nems stopped work, and attacked the Tobors. Now there was no danger from the Tobors. Their power had gone. Soon, the city belonged to the Nems.

Derf was the hero of the city.

He was happy. His people were free. But he still needed to ask some more questions. Who were the Tobors? Where had they come from? Would they ever come back?

Derf stood in front of the giant computer at The Centre. It was running down now. But a few lights were still on and some sounds came from it. It would answer a few questions before it broke down completely.

The computer's voice was weak and Derf had to listen very carefully to the answers.

"Robots were made by men," it said. "Robots must never kill men. Robots must..."

The voice died away. There was silence. And then, Derf understood.

"We're not Nems." he said to himself. "We are men. Men and women." As time passed the names got mixed up. It's all clear now. Nem is man. Tobor is robot!"

He stood and looked at the computer. Before the war, people had made robot to help them. After the war, the robots took over. People became the slaves of machines.

This must never happen again, Derf said, "We must make a new world outside this city. From now on, machines must be our slaves.

Read-16
Counting Sheep

"Now it's time to go home" said Dr. Shalini Singh after a day's work. It was 07.45 pm. She stood up and began to put her things together in her bag.

But before she could take a step forward, there came a dog - the largest dog she had ever seen. He couldn't walk properly. He was about to collapse (fall down). His legs were splayed out (spread out wide apart). With eyes open, he was taking a quick breath with his mouth open.

Dr. Shalini Singh immediately went into action. She opened her bag, took out the stethoscope, turned the dog to his other side and searched for the heart. The sound that came through the stethoscope was like hoof-boats, clear and strong. All his other systems were working well. "Get up" said Dr. Shalini Singh quickly "You are fit and fine".

"Who, me?" muttered the dog, eyes still rolling. "Who says I am fit and fine?"

I do, What is wrong with you, anyway ?"

"Everything, doctor. Absolutely everything, I just can't sleep.

Dr. Shalini replied "Hm....if you move to the chairs, we could talk."

The dog rolled over on his stomach and walked unsteadily. Dr. Shalini cleared her throat.

"First of all, tell me how did you become so large?"

"One of my forefathers was Great Wolves."

"I see. Mixed up genes and all that." Muttered Dr. Shalini and wrote down something rapidly on tier pad.

"How long have you been suffering from insomnia (inability to sleep)?"

"Oh, nearly two months now."

"Any major change in diet in recent weeks

"Doctor, naturally. I have to eat more now to keep up my energy." said the patient painfully.

"And it shows. Particularly around the waist. What time do you go to bed?"

"Oh, around ten at night. I keep the same hours as humans as I work for them."

"Have you tried anything to promote sleep?"

"Haven't I, now? I have tried a walk just before bedtime. I have tried a hot drink-, I have tried a cold drink. I have tried a full meal. I have tried no meal.... ... But nothing works."

"Well" said the doctor, "Doctors have recommended one remedy for sleeplessness Counting imaginary sheep."

Do you agree to what the doctor suggested? How does it help?

The patient's eyes opened wide. His nostrils ballooned. He jumped on his feet. "Doctor, don't mention that word in my presence, for heaven's sake. I do nothing but count sheep all day. I am Mik, the sheep dog! "

"That should not make you sleepless."

"Ah, but it does. It is those dumb things I chase around all day I have to go looking for them up the hills and down, in and out of bushes, behind fence, into caves..."

"Relax, relax" said the doctor. "Don't take strain."

"You would also get strained (tension) if you had to look after sheep for a living. It is the most boring, uninspiring, exhausting and dead end job. At the end of the day, I am so frustrated (annoyed, upset) that I can't sleep."

"Why don't you look for a change?"

"How can I?"

"Okay - okay, don't worry, we will put you right soon."

"Sleeping pills ?"asked the sheep-dog.

"No, no. You must not get used to sleeping pills. Bad habit. Do this. When you go home, change the position of your bed and instead of sheep, count crows."

A ray of hope lit up the patient's eyes. "That sounds good. I am sick of counting sheep. Thank you doctor. See you soon."

Two days later he was back again. Doctor Shalini took a look at him and knew that he was worse.

"Oh, doctor." he wailed.

"I kept counting crows in my imagination and they kept cawing."

"Hm," said the doctor. "I can see that counting- is not your strong point. It only upsets you."

"it always did. I used to howl in the arithmetic class at school."

"Okay. We will drop counting, shall we? Forget that you ever learnt to say 1, 2, 3, 4..... Instead imagine you are in a garden, with lots of beautiful, colourful flowers."

"Grass, too ?"said the sheep-dog.

"Yes, yes."

"And a beach ball ? It is fun to chase a ball on soft green grass.

"Will you let me do the talking?" said the doctor. In that garden, you won't be a sheep-dog. You will be a honey bee. Going buzz-buzz-buzz from flower to flow er. Simple, try it for a couple of days. It works like a charm."

"I am hopeful. Thanks. See you on Friday."

Do you think this technique will work?

But he never turned up on Friday. On Saturday, he rushed in, more worried than ever and said. "Doctor, will you please do something to stop buzzing in my head ?"

"Open your eyes." said the doctor quickly, "and look at me."

The patient obeyed. "And now where are the bees?"

The sheep-dog shook his head. "Can't say. They flew away."

"Listen" said the doctor. "I was at your place of work today. In fact, I saw you in action. Even talked to some of your flock."

"Oh, those," the sheep-dog made a face. "You need not have taken the trouble. Sheep can't think for themselves."

"Well, let me tell you most of them do and they think you are unpleasant, short tempered, impatient, unreasonable bully."

The patient leapt to his feet and got shocked. "How can they say like this? I always struggle to keep them together and save them out of any harm."

"That is it. You keep them together by bullying them into a tight bunch. You won't let them step out of the circle. You don't even allow them to search for juicy grass."

"Bah! They are eating all the time as it is" said the sheep dog. But he didn't sound quite as angry as before.

"They eat all right" said the doctor. "But what they need is a little more freedom and little more peace. Not somebody barking at them all the time."

"I never thought of that!"

"And have you ever thought why you can't sleep

The dog kept quite. "It is because you bark at. the sheep all day. You growl (how, rumble) by day and simply can't sleep by night. If you give the sheep more freedom, you will definitely sleep by night."

There was a silence in the room. Then slowly the sheep dog rose to his feet. "Hats off to you, doctor" he said "I believe this time you have got it."

"Report back, will you

"Sure" said the sheep-dog. He waged his tail and went off.

A week later, Dr. Shalini received a post with her fees and a thank you card. The dog wrote:

Sleeping like a log
Miko, the sheep-dog.

At the end of the letter, there was a line.

'Doctor, can you help me keep awake by day

Read-1 7
How to Kill by Kindness

"Children", said a kind father to his little family, as he took a seat by the fireside and gathered them around him, "which is the best way to kill an enemy

"Why, shoot him, to be sure," said one. "No, stab him," said the second. "No, starve him," said the third.

"But I think," said their father, "I can show you a better way than this. An enemy may be killed without taking his life, or shedding a single drop of his blood. Let me tell you a story to show how it may be done."

What story would the father tell?

"There was a farmer, once, who was cross and surly (unfriendly) and a very disagreeable man. Everyone who knew him disliked him. He was sure to make the most of whatever went wrong about him; and the poor offender always met with severe punishment. There was not a boy in all the neighborhood who did not feel uncomfortable as he passed his gate; and the poor dog that barked at his geese, or the neighbour's rooster that crowed on his wall, was speedily visited either with the lash of hi whip (blow or stroke with a whip), or the shot from his gun. The very cat knew his footsteps, and slunk away (moved away) from him in terror. He was a complete pest, so much so to himself as to those about him. Every day brought him some fresh trouble, and found him in continual 'hot water' (in a difficult situation); Indeed, his very life was made up of broils (full of tensions).

After a time, good Farmer Green came to live near him; and, as you may suppose he was soon told the character of his not over pleasant neighbour. "Well", said he, "if he treats me badly, I'll very soon kill him."

This remark of Farmer Green's soon got abroad, and all sorts of things were said about it. He seemed the very last man to 'kill' anyone, for his looks and words and actions, all told of a loving heart. Nobody could think for a moment of his becoming a murderer. Mr. Green's intention at length came to the ears of the ill-natured farmer, and you may be sure he was not at all pleased about it. Everything he could do to tease, annoy and even injure. Mr Green was done. But somehow or other the man who was to 'kill' this ugly-tempered farmer took it all in good part (take), and spoke as calmly, and looked as kindly as ever.

One day, Mr Green sent to the wife of our surly friend a basket of nice plums; but her husband wouldn't let her have them. He told the person who brought them, very gruffly, that it was only done to get some of his pears in return, and he was not going to give any of them away.

At another time, Mr Green's team of oxen stuck fast in a bog, and when he asked his neighbour for a little help, he told him, in a very rough way, that he had enough to do to mind his own business, and refused to help him.

"Never mind," said Green to someone standing by, "I'll kill him very soon, see if I don't."

Soon after this, the team of the ill-natured man was in the same plight (in a dangerous or difficult situation) that his neighbours had been in. Mr Green saw it. He ran for his oxen

and chains, and set off to the gloss. He spoke kindly, offered his help, and began to render it; but what did he receive in reply? Why, a fierce look and an angry word! "I don't want your help! Take your oxen away."

"No," said the other, "I must help you, for the night is coming on, and what is bad enough by day is ten times worse in the dark." Away pulled the oxen and the men, and soon all was set straight again

That evening the ill-natured man had a strange feeling - something, which he had never felt before. And his wife gave him a strange look as he said, "Peg, Farmer Green has killed me! He said he would and he has done it."

What are your feelings for the bad tempered farmer now?

Yes, the 'enemy' was 'killed' without the loss of a single life, or shedding even a single drop of blood. He went in the morning to confess his ingratitude to his kind neighbour, and to ask his forgiveness, and the very man who had been noted for nothing but his wickedness became the friend of all.

There is the greatest difference in the world between conquering by power, and conquering by kindness. The former is like building a dam across a stream of water. It may stop its flow for a little while, but presently the dam will give way, and then the stream will rush on with more force and fury than ever. Conquering by power is like changing a lion; conquering by kindness keeps the lion from doing harm, by changing his nature, and turning him into a lamb.

Do you agree to farmer Green's attitude? Why?

Read-18
An Accident

If everything goes as per the plan in any event or travel, we may enjoy it but don't remember it after some time. On the other hand if something doesn't happen as per plan, on successful completion of the activity we feel greater satisfaction and a sense of fulfillment. I felt the same after the trek of Manimaheshvia Sari Pass.

Chamba Valley in the Himalaya is surrounded by high mountains from three sides. Ravi flows in the centre. Pir Panjal Range is in the North and in the West one can enjoy panoramic view of the Dhauladhar Range. Manimahesh in the Himalaya is a 18556 ft high Mountain in the middle of these ranges. At the feet of the mountain is the Manimahesh lake. Manimahesh Yatra is almost equivalent (same) toAmarnath Yatra. The traditional route goes from Bhrammaur (Bharmor), Hadsar to Manimahesh, But we in a group of 15 chose an untraditional route i.e. Chamba - Holy - Tyori -Kalah - Jail Kahd - Sukhdali - Sari Pass (a path that allows the crossing of moutain chain) - Manirnahesh Interesting names, aren't they?

As per plan, we started our trek from Tyori. We arrived at Holy by jeep and trekked up to Tyori. We reached there in the evening and took shelter in the primary school with the help of the local teachers. Every place in the Himalaya offers a view, The view of snow covered Talang Pass from the school was soothing after 8 hrsjourney by vehicle and two hours walk. It was a mixed group with Shri Manmohansingh Bawa, running 76, the eldest and the most experienced trekker and Gulal being the youngest at the age of 12.

The leader of the group, an experienced mountaineer and trekker, announced the next day's plan. The next day, we left very early after the breakfast and reached Kalah in the late afternoon after almost 11 km's trek. The trek was beautiful. We could see Ravi for some time as we gained height. We discovered some villages on the slopes that we couldn't see before. At around 1 pm, the clouds started gathering on the horizon and soon they covered the whole sky. It started drizzling (light rain). Bawaji explained the young trekkers a few characteristics of typical Himalayan weather. He said that it's always better to start early and reach the next destination by afternoon, as late afternoon showers are common in the mountains,

Kalah was a small and beautiful village with a population of only 200. We took shelter in a Sarai, a small house with a kitchen and a hall, constructed for the pilgrims (people who make ajourney to holy place). The evening was very cold with temperature around 7-8^0 c degree temperature. It further dropped at night to 2-3^0 c. Our cook, who had joined us from Tyori cooked food for us. We had a welcome hot dinner followed by a sound sleep in the warmth of our sleeping bags. The morning in Kalah was beautiful. Everyone was at ease as it was acclimatization (to become used to the conditions) halt. It was a rich mix in the true sense of the term as there were painters, writers, photographers, ornithologists and adventure lovers. Someone took a sketch book and a pencil and started sketching beautiful wooden houses of the village. A few of us captured beautiful views and Himalayan village life in our camera. Ornithologists took their binocular and started studying the variety of birds. Our local guide, Sansar Chand, informed us about a temple at some height from the village. Bawaji and I visited the temple.

Everything was going as per the plan. The next day we started early in the morning to reach Jail Khad. But the weather didn't favour us. Moreover, one of the team members was tired and was unable to walk. So we decided to halt early near a stream. There was a Gaddi (shepherd) already there with his sheep. We cleaned and leveled the ground to erect the tents. We divided ourselves in different tents. Meanwhile, the kitchen tent was also ready and we enjoyed hot soup before meal. The weather cleared in the evening and everyone was out of the tents. Bawaji took us to the Gaddi. We were surprised to know that they live in such cold and hard Himalayan weather without a tent or even a sleeping, bag for months together. His only company was a Himalayan Shepherd dog who helped him in protecting and managing the sheep. The Gaddhi informed us of heavy snow on the pass and in Sukhdali, our next destination. Generally, the snow melts by late May but due to late winter heavy snow fall it was still there. When we returned to our tents we found one more group of ten young and enthusiastic trekkers who was going on the same route.

The next morning the weather worsened, For many of us it was the first experience of snow fall. It was a complete whiteout but we were safe in our tents. The team leader and Bawaji discussed the matter and decided not to proceed until the weather clears as our next destination was Sukhdali. The Gaddi also advised both the parties the same thing. However, the young, enthusiastic trekkers didn't take a serious note of it and started towards Sukhdali. The Gaddi was worried, he showed his concern but they didn't listen to him. The bad weather continued throughout the day.

In the late afternoon, a porter of the group that left in the morning came running towards the campsite. He informed us that one of the boys had fallen into a crevasse (a large

deep crack in thick ice or rock) near Sukhdali. He did not have a stick to test the snow covered ground for hidden crevasse and had paid the price for his carelessness.

Our team leader knew that there was not a moment to be lost. The freezing cold and the reduced supply of oxygen would cause the body's temperature to drop below normal. Hypothermia (dangerously low body temperature) would set in and the boy would go into a coma. He asked Sansar Chand, the local guide, to collect ropes, a flask of tea, a torch and a blanket. We rushed to the sight with the Gaddi and a few local porters.

"Can you hear me?", the team leader shouted,

He was relieved a bit to hear the boy's reply though his voice sounded faint. He could not have fallen too deep. There was hope yet.

A jacket was lowered first. The boy was asked to stay still so that he does not lose his footing and fall further down. When the ropes were being joined together our team leader kept on talking to the boy and made him respond. He wanted him to keep awake because he knew that the lower oxygen would make him sleepy. And if the succumbed (give in, to do something against the will because of pressure of compulsion) to sleep, it would be a sleep forever.

The rope was ready with a bowline knot with a loop large enough to fit around the boy's chest. The rope was lowered with a torch. The boy was asked to tug the rope when he was ready. Slowly and carefully, we pulled the boy out. He was immediately wrapped in a blanked and then we gave him some hot tea. lie was carried back to the campsite. The boy thanked our team lender again and again, "Without you, Sahib, he would have been in heaven by now!", said the Gaddi to make the atmosphere light,

The next morning, the sky cleared and it was time to bid adieu (to say good bye) to the Gaddi. As a parting note, the Gaddi wished us all the best and added: "Never go against nature. She has her own rules. If you break them and try to go against nature, you are sure to get punished."

Read-19
The Little Prince

Once when I was six years old, I saw a beautiful picture in a book about the primeval (ancient) forest called True Stories. It showed a boa constrictor swallowing an animal. Here is a copy of the drawing.

The book stated: 'Boa-constrictors swallow their prey whole without chewing it whereupon they can no longer move and sleep for six months digesting it.' I then reflected deeply upon the adventures in the jungle and in turn succeeded in making my first drawing with a colour pencil. My drawing No. 1 was like this

I showed my masterpiece to the grown-ups and asked them if my drawing frightened them.

They answered: 'Why should anyone be frightened by a hat?' My drawing did not represent a hat; It was ... supposed to be a boa constrictor digesting an elephant:' So I made another drawing of the of the boa constrictor to enable the grown ups to understand. They always need explanations. My drawing. No. 2 looked like this:

The grown-ups then advised me to give up my drawings of boa constrictors, whether from the inside or the outside, and devote myself instead to geography, history, arithmetic and grammar. Thus I gave up a magnificent (very good) career as a painter at the age of six. I had been disappointed by the lack of success of my drawing No. 1 and My drawing No.2. Grown-ups never understand anything by themselves. It is rather tedious (boring) for children to have to explain things to them time and again.

So I had to choose another job and I learnt to pilot aeroplanes. I flew more or less all over the world. And indeed geography has been extremely useful to me. I am able to distinguish between China and Arizona at a glance. It is extremely helpful if one gets lost in the night.

As a result of which I have been in touch, throughout my life, with all kinds of serious people. I have spent a lot of time with grown-ups. I have seen them at very close quarters which I'm afraid has not greatly enhanced my opinion of them.

Whenever I met one who seemed reasonably clear-sighted d to me, I showed them my drawing No 1, which I have preserved 'as an experiment. I wanted to find out whether he or she was truly understanding. But, the answer was always: 'It is a hat.' So I gave up mentioning boa constrictors or primeval forests or stars. I would bring myself down to his or her level and talk about bridge, golf, politics and neckties. And the grown-up would be very pleased to have met such a sensible person.

Read-21
Fun Time

God Will Provide

A young woman brought her fiancé home to meet her parents. After dinner her father asked the young man into his study for a chat. "So, what are your plans?" he began.

"I'm a theology scholar," the young man replied.

"Admirable," the father said, "but what will you do to provide a nice home for my daughter?"

"I will study and God will provide." He explained

"And how will you afford to raise children."

"God will provide."

The men left the study and the mother asked her husband. "How'd it go?"

"He has no money or employment plans," the fattier said. "But on the other hand, he thinks I'm God".

Wrong Shopping

Mrs Black was having a lot of trouble with her skin, so she talked to her doctor about it. He could find nothing wrong with her, however, he sent her to the local hospital for some tests. The hospital, of course, sent the results of the tests direct to Mrs Black's doctor, and the next morning he telephoned her to give her a list of the things that he thought she should not eat, as any of them might be a cause of her skin trouble.

Mrs Black carefully wrote all the things down on a piece of paper, which she then left beside the telephone while she went out to a ladies' meeting.

When she got back home two hours later, she found her husband waiting for her. He had a big basket full of packages beside him, and when he saw her, he said, "Hello, dear, I have done all your shopping for you."

"Done all my shopping?" She asked in surprise. "But how did you know what I wanted ?"

"Well, when I got home, I found your shopping list beside the telephone", answered her husband, "so I went down to the shops and bought everything you had written down".

Of course, Mrs. Black had to tell him that he had bought all the things the doctor did not allow her to eat!

Johnny is Busy

It was half past eight in the morning. The telephone bell rang and Lucy went to answer it.

"Hello, who's that ?" she asked

"It's me - Peter"

Peter was a friend of Lucy's eight year old brother, Johnny.

"Oh, hello, Peter, What do you want ?" said Lucy

"Can I speak to Johnny"

"No," said Mary, "you can't speak to him now. He is getting ready for schoot, He is eating his breakfast- Grand mother is combing his hair. Sister is under the table, putting his shoes on. Mother is getting his books and putting them in his school bag. Goodbye, I've got to go now. I have to hold the door open. The school bus is coming."

You are here as a Monkey

A young lion came to a small zoo in Europe. In the next cage was a tired, old lion, which did nothing except lie about and sleep. Lions ought not to behave like that! 'the young lion said to himself, so he roared at all the visitors and tried to break the bars of the cage.

At three o'clock a man brought a big piece of meat and put it in the old lion's cage. Then he put a bag of nuts and two bananas in the young lion's cage.

The young lion was very surprised. "I don't understand this", he said to the old lion. "I behave like a real lion, while you lie there and do nothing, and look what happens!"

"Well, you see", said the old lion kindly, "this is a small zoo. They haven't got enough money for two lions, so in their books you are here as a monkey."

A Golf Ball

The new nurse was watching her first operation in the theatre and asked: "Who are they operating on ?" She was old, "It's some poor chap who had a golf ball knocked down his throat." So the nurse said: "I suppose that poor worried looking old man waiting outside is his father came the answer: "No Its that chap's ball, and he's waiting to get on with his game."

Money, Money, Money

If a man runs after money, he's money mad- If he keeps it, he's a capitalist.

If he spends it, he's a spineless playboy.

If he doesn't get it, he lacks ambition

If he gets it without working, he's a rotten parasite.

If he gets it after a lifetime of grueling hard labour he's a stupid fool who got nothing out of life.

So what's a fellow to do?

Daddy's Boiling

Little Anne's father fell asleep on the sofa and began to snore. The child ran out into the corridor and shouted, "Mummy, come quickly. Daddy's boiling.

A Renewed Contract

Our neighbour's son Suchit would rather play football than do his home work. His marks were so poor at the end of the school year that he had to stay behind. This is how he put it to his parents: 'My contract with the present school class has been renewed for another year.

Tom's Letters

Tom was only seven years old, so when he went off to camp with a lot of other small boys one summer" his mother thought that he might be happy and arranged for all his aunts and his grandmother and all his other relatives to write to him, so that he would get a letter every day while he was away from home.

Well, of course he did not write to anybody while he was at the camp. Afew days after he came back home, his mother saw him looking at some papers and asked him what they were.

"Oh," he said, "they are the letters I got while I was at the camp. I did not have time to look at them while I was there."

Experiment

The science teacher believed very strongly in practical work as a means of teaching science effectively, and she wanted her pupils' parents to see how well their children were learning by her methods. She therefore arranged for all the parents to come and see the results of one of the experiments carried by children on a Saturday evening, when all of them were free,

The children had been studying the growth of plants, and they had planted four pots of beans a few weeks before. They had put poor soil in one pot, to see what effect this would have on the growth of the beans in it, and good seen in the other three pots. Then they had put one of the post in the dark for several days and had given a third pot, no water for the same length of time.

At the end of the lesson on Friday afternoon, the teacher put little notices on the four pots, 'The beans in this pot were planted in poor soil'. This pot has been kept in the dark for four days. These beans have had no water for four days. These beans have had good soil, plenty of light and regular water. Then, the teacher went home.

When she arrived on Saturday evening, half an hour before the parents were due to come, she found this note besides the pots: We read your notes to the school servant and thought we would help him, so we watered all the plants, changed the earth in the one with

poor soil, and left the light on above the one that had been left in the dark for four days. We hope that the plants will now grow better.

'yours friends,"

'The Boy Scouts'.

Read-22

You Cannot but Communicate....

The proverb "action speaks louder than words" holds true. In a given situation, even if you do not communicate verbally, your body speaks by revealing your feelings and emotions. Certain messages are better conveyed through your body language. Body language and nonverbal communication go hand in hand.

Body language is an integral (fundamental) part of the selection criteria at a job interview. A candidate may not be aware that there is someone among the interview panel who is studying his/her body language. Body language is read by observing the body posture (pose), the eye movements and the rhythm of breathing. One of the skills a human resource manager should possess is the ability to read the body language. This would help him while conducting interviews or imparting training to employees. Reading body language is a skill that could be acquired through training and practice.

- Head - face, forehead, eyes, eyebrows, cheek, chin, mouth
- Arms - elbow, hands, fingers
- Legs - knees, foot
- Torso -shoulder, back, hips

Let's have a look at a few examples of body language.

Eye Contact Maintaining a good eye contact shows respect and interest in what people have to say. Posture is the nest thing to master. When the posture is right we automatically start feeling better as it makes us fell good almost instantly. Chances are that we'll be slouched (stand, move or sit on a dropping fashion) over with our shoulders drooping down and inward. This collapses (breakdown) the best and inhibits good breathing, which in turn can make us feel nervous or uncomfortable.

Head position is a great one to play around with, with one self and others. When we want to feel confident and self assured, keep the head level both horizontally as well a vertically. One can also use this straight head position when one wants to be authoritative and what s/he is saying is to be taken seriously. Conversely when one wants to be friendly and in the listening, receptive mode, tilt (lean, slant) the head just a little to one side or other. We can shift the tilt your head just a little to one side or other. He can shift the tilt from left to right at different point during the conversation.

Arms give away the clues as to how open and receptive we are to everyone we meet and interact with, so keep your arms out to the side of your body or behind your back. The more outgoing you are as a person, the more you tend to use your arms with big movements. The quieter you are the less you move your arms away from your body. So, try to strike a natural balance and keep your arm movements midway. When you want to come across in the best possible light, crossing the arms is a 'NO'. Crossed arms suggest you are not receptive. really don't agree with, then by all means show your disapproval (condemnation, denial, refusal) by crossing them!

They tend to move around a lot more than normal when we are nervous, stressed or being deceptive (illusory). So best keep them as still as possible in most situations, especially at interviews or work meetings. Be careful too in the way you cross your legs.

Do you cross at the knees, ankles or bring your leg up to rest on the knee of the other ?

Hand gestures are so numerous. But here are some basic ones. Palms slightly up and outward is seen as open friendly. Palm down gestures are generally seen as dominant, emphasizing and possibi y aggressive, especially when there is no movement or bending between the wrist and the forearm. This palm up palm down is very important when it comes to handshaking and where appropriate.

Mouth movements can give away all sorts of clues. We purse our lips and sometimes twist them to the side when we're thinking. Another occasion on which we might use this movement is to hold back an angry comment we don't wish to reveal. Nevertheless, it will probably be spotted by other people and although they may not know the comment, they will get a feeling you were not pleased. There are also different types of smiles and each gives off a corresponding feeling to its recipient which we'll cover next time.

Do remember:

(1) Nothing crossed. Keep arms, legs, and feet relaxed and uncrossed. Also, if you are wearing a jacket, open it up. It conveys the message ..... I am open and honest with you.

(2) Lean forward. Move with 6 to 8 feet from the other person. Lean slightly forward. Interested people always pay attention and lean forward. Leaning backwards demonstrates aloofness or rejection.

(3) Direct eye contact. Direct eye contact is a compliment to most people and builds trust in you. But be aware of the customs of people from other countries. It may be a sign of disrespect.

(4) Handshake. Not too hard and not too soft. Pay attention to how you are shaking someone's hand.